

# PitchYard 6-Month Support Model

From Idea to Investment-Ready

## Model Overview

The PitchYard Support Model is a six-phase progression framework designed to guide idea-stage and early-stage healthtech innovators through structured steps that transform raw ideas into investment-ready ventures. Each phase builds on the last, with flexibility to account for pivots, new insights, or early exits.

The model rests on three pillars:

1. Validation – founders test assumptions with real users and markets.
2. Iteration – founders refine their solutions through prototypes and pilots.
3. Readiness – founders develop the tools, proof, and story needed to attract partners and investors.

## Conceptual Flow

**Input** → Early-stage founder with an idea

**Process** → 6 guided phases (reflection → validation → testing → prototyping → partnership prep → investment readiness)

**Output** → Founder exits with one or more of:

- Validated problem statement
- Proof of market interest
- Prototype or MVP tested in real life
- Investor/partner-ready pitch pack

## **Phases of the Model**

### **Phase 1: Reflection & Focus (2 weeks)**

- Activity: Reflection form + roadmap
- Mechanism: Structured self-assessment and goal-setting
- Output: Clear 3-step action plan + 6-month roadmap

### **Phase 2: Understanding the Problem (3–4 weeks)**

- Activity: 10–15 user interviews; simple sketches/mockups
- Mechanism: Problem discovery and validation
- Output: Evidence that the problem is real and urgent

### **Key questions for Phase 1 & 2**

- Does the problem even exist in the way I think it does?
- Who exactly experiences this problem most, and how urgent is it for them?
- How are people currently solving (or struggling with) this problem?
- Are there enough people or organizations with this problem to make my idea worth building?
- Would anyone actually care if my solution disappeared tomorrow?

### **Phase 3: Testing the Idea (3–4 weeks)**

- Activity: Build a basic version (sketch, WhatsApp flow, demo); test with 5–10 people
- Mechanism: Early solution testing + initial partner interest
- Output: Proof of early demand (LoI, pilot interest, positive user reactions)

### **Phase 4: Prototype or Small Pilot (4 weeks)**

- Activity: Build small working prototype; run pilot with few users/site
- Mechanism: Real-world testing under controlled scope
- Output: Evidence of usability, value, and measurable impact (2–3 KPIs)

### **Key questions for phase 3 & 4**

- Does my solution make sense to the people I'm building for?
- When I show a simple version (sketch, demo, prototype), do people "get it"?
- Does it solve the problem better, cheaper, or faster than what exists today?
- What do early users complain about or suggest to improve?
- If I test this with a small group/site, do they continue using it after the first try?

**Phase 5: Getting Ready for Partners (3–4 weeks)**

- Activity: Prepare short pack (problem, solution, results, next steps)
- Mechanism: Synthesis and communication of evidence
- Output: Partner-ready proof pack

**Phase 6: Preparing for Investment (3–4 weeks)**

- Activity: Create 10–12 slide investor deck; practice pitches
- Mechanism: Investor readiness training + narrative building
- Output: Investment-ready presentation + confidence in approaching accelerators, angels, or grants

**Key questions for phase 5 & 6**

- Can I clearly explain the problem, my solution, and why it matters in 2–3 minutes?
- Do I have at least some evidence — stories, data, or letters of intent — that shows demand?
- Do I understand how this solution could eventually make money or sustain itself?
- Can I answer, “Why now? Why me/us?” with confidence?
- Do I have a simple roadmap of what I’ll do with the next funding or partnership?

## **Conditional Branching**

The model allows for different outcomes:

- Validated → Prototype → Investor-ready (ideal path)
- Validated problem but weak solution → Pivot documented → Restart cycle
- Invalidated problem → Exit with clear insights, saving resources

## **Impact Pathway**

- Inputs: Early-stage founders, PitchYard platform, mentors/builders, tools, partner networks
- Activities: Reflection, validation interviews, prototyping, pilots, storytelling, pitch preparation
- Outputs: Proof packs, prototypes, pitch decks, partner MoUs, investor-ready founders
- Outcomes: Founders gain clarity, traction, and readiness to scale
- Impact: Stronger pipeline of investable African healthtech startups